

D648

Leveraging AI and Technology in Strategic Communications

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A communications specialist at a regional hospital with a new helipad uses a generative AI tool to draft a news release. The draft cites a 2023 study with a precise statistic. The tool produced the draft in under a minute. What must happen before publication?

- A. Publish; AI tools are accurate with numbers.
- B. Check the study and statistic against the original source.
- C. Edit only for tone.
- D. Add a line about the new helipad.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An AI tool gives a quote it attributes to a real industry report. A staffer checks the report and finds no such quote. What is this called?

- A. Algorithmic bias
- B. Plagiarism
- C. A hallucination
- D. A deepfake

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A city government communications office with 14 staff uses AI to create a photorealistic image of a planned park for a mailer to residents. The mayor likes the design. What is best practice?

- A. Label it as an AI-generated concept illustration.
- B. No label, because it is for a public project.
- C. Add a label only if a resident asks.
- D. The mayor's approval makes a label unnecessary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An agency with a new office dog uses AI to create images of “a CEO” and “a nurse” for a campaign. Every CEO image shows an older white man; every nurse image shows a young woman. What is the best response?

- A. Use them; AI is neutral math.
- B. Recognize training-data bias, then revise prompts and review images for fair representation.
- C. Never use AI images again.
- D. Add the office dog to each image.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A PR manager at a law firm with offices in two states wants a free public AI chatbot to summarize a confidential client settlement before a press call. What should she do?

- A. Tell the chatbot to keep the information secret.
- B. Paste it, then delete the chat afterward.
- C. It’s only a problem if the client is in another state.
- D. Not paste it into the public tool; use an approved tool with data protections or remove identifying details.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under a typical company AI policy, which content is safe to put into a public generative AI tool?

- A. The customer email list.
- B. Employee health records.
- C. A press release already published, to turn into social posts.
- D. Unreleased quarterly earnings.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A marketing team at an outdoor-gear brand with a new logo creates a campaign slogan and illustration entirely with AI and wants to register the copyright. Under current U.S. Copyright Office guidance, what is the issue?

- A. The copyright belongs automatically to the AI vendor.
- B. It belongs to the brand because it paid for the tool.
- C. Material made solely by AI generally isn't copyrightable without human authorship.
- D. The new logo must be registered first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

What would make an AI-assisted illustration more likely to be protectable?

- A. Buying a premium version of the tool.
- B. A designer substantially selecting, arranging, and modifying the elements.
- C. Writing a longer, more detailed prompt.
- D. Nothing; AI-assisted work can never be protected.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A startup with 25 employees wants to use AI to clone its retired founder's voice for an anniversary video. The founder moved abroad last year. What is required?

- A. No consent, since he has retired.
- B. Skip consent because he now lives abroad.
- C. No consent, since he founded the company.
- D. The founder's informed consent, plus disclosure that the voice is synthetic.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

The communications VP at a food company with a test kitchen is asked to lead her team in setting AI guidelines. What should be the core of the guidelines?

- A. Allow AI only for test-kitchen recipes.
- B. Let each person decide how to use AI.
- C. Ban all AI use.
- D. Human review and accountability for AI-assisted content, with approved tools, disclosure rules, and data limits.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A communications coordinator at an insurance company whose office overlooks a river asks an AI tool, “Write a post.” The result is generic. What is the best improvement?

- A. Add the audience, goal, key message, tone, format, and length.
- B. Type the prompt in all capital letters.
- C. Mention the river view.
- D. Run the same prompt again.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An AI tool returned a 600-word formal post, but the team wanted a short, casual caption for teenagers on a video app. What was most likely missing from the prompt?

- A. The audience, platform, and format.
- B. A request for a longer word count.
- C. The topic.
- D. Nothing; AI output is random.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A communications specialist at a regional hospital ~~with a new helipad~~ uses a generative AI tool to draft a news release. The draft cites a 2023 study with a precise statistic. ~~The tool produced the draft in under a minute.~~ What must happen before publication?

Target word: required step **Decides:** AI can invent plausible citations.

A	Absolute language	AI regularly produces false specifics.
B	Correct	AI can fabricate sources; a human must verify.
C	Dropped element	Leaves the factual claim unverified.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant to accuracy.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

An AI tool gives a quote it attributes to a real industry report. A staffer checks the report and finds no such quote. What is this called?

Target word: name the failure **Decides:** Fabricated content presented as fact.

A	Confusion set	Bias is skewed output, not invented facts.
B	Adjacent category	Plagiarism copies real text; this text doesn't exist.
C	Correct	The model generated a plausible but false quote.
D	Inverted operation	Deepfakes are synthetic media of real people.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A city government communications office ~~with 14 staff~~ uses AI to create a photorealistic image of a planned park for a mailer to residents. ~~The mayor likes the design.~~ What is best practice?

Target word: disclosure **Decides:** Realistic image of something that doesn't exist.

A	Correct	Prevents residents from mistaking it for a real photo.
B	Dropped element	Purpose doesn't remove the risk of misleading.
C	Inverted operation	Disclosure must come first, not on request.
D	Camouflage	Approval doesn't inform the audience.

4. Answer B Concept 3

An agency ~~with a new office dog~~ uses AI to create images of "a CEO" and "a nurse" for a campaign. Every CEO image shows an older white man; every nurse image shows a young woman. What is the best response?

Target word: respond to biased output **Decides:** Stereotyped output from training data.

A	Inverted operation	AI reflects the biases in its data.
B	Correct	Humans must correct bias the model reproduces.
C	Absolute language	Review and correction solve it without a ban.
D	Camouflage	Doesn't address representation.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A PR manager at a law firm ~~with offices in two states~~ wants a free public AI chatbot to summarize a confidential client settlement before a press call. What should she do?

Target word: confidentiality step **Decides:** Confidential client data and a public tool.

A	Adjacent category	A prompt can't control how the provider handles data.
B	Dropped element	Deleting doesn't guarantee the data wasn't kept.
C	Camouflage	Geography doesn't change confidentiality.
D	Correct	Public tools may retain or use what is entered.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Under a typical company AI policy, which content is safe to put into a public generative AI tool?

Target word: find the safe input **Decides:** Already public, no personal data.

A	Adjacent category	Personal data.
B	Confusion set	Sensitive personal data.
C	Correct	Public information with no confidential data.
D	Inverted operation	Confidential until released.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A marketing team at an outdoor-gear brand ~~with a new logo~~ creates a campaign slogan and illustration entirely with AI and wants to register the copyright. Under current U.S. Copyright Office guidance, what is the issue?

Target word: copyright status **Decides:** No human authorship.

A	Adjacent category	Lack of human authorship means no one gets it automatically.
B	Absolute language	Payment doesn't create authorship.
C	Correct	Copyright requires human creative contribution.
D	Camouflage	Unrelated to the AI output.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

What would make an AI-assisted illustration more likely to be protectable?

Target word: what adds protection **Decides:** Meaningful human creative control.

A	Inverted operation	Payment doesn't create authorship.
B	Correct	Human creative contribution can be protected.
C	Confusion set	Prompts alone are generally not enough.
D	Absolute language	Human-authored parts can be.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A startup ~~with 25 employees~~ wants to use AI to clone its retired founder's voice for an anniversary video. ~~The founder moved abroad last year.~~ What is required?

Target word: requirement **Decides:** A real person's voice.

A	Adjacent category	Retirement doesn't end his rights.
B	Camouflage	Location doesn't remove the need for consent.
C	Inverted operation	Founding a company doesn't give it rights to his voice.
D	Correct	A person controls use of their likeness and voice.

10. Answer D Concept 7

The communications VP at a food company ~~with a test kitchen~~ is asked to lead her team in setting AI guidelines. What should be the core of the guidelines?

Target word: core of AI policy **Decides:** Human accountability with clear limits.

A	Camouflage	Not a governance framework.
B	Dropped element	No shared standards.
C	Absolute language	Gives up real productivity gains.
D	Correct	Balances use with ethics and control.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A communications coordinator at an insurance company ~~whose office overlooks a river~~ asks an AI tool, "Write a post." The result is generic. What is the best improvement?

Target word: better prompt **Decides:** The prompt gives no context.

A	Correct	Context drives relevant output.
B	Adjacent category	Emphasis doesn't add information.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the post.
D	Dropped element	Same missing context, same result.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

An AI tool returned a 600-word formal post, but the team wanted a short, casual caption for teenagers on a video app. What was most likely missing from the prompt?

Target word: infer missing prompt element **Decides:** Output mismatched audience and format.

A	Correct	Without them, the tool defaulted to a generic formal post.
B	Inverted operation	They needed shorter.
C	Confusion set	The topic was right; the form was wrong.
D	Absolute language	Output follows the prompt's context.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Hallucination and verification	Generative AI can produce fluent but false facts and citations; a human must verify every claim against the original source.	Trusting confident, well-formatted output.	AI output containing statistics, quotes, or citations.
2	Disclosing AI-generated content	Label realistic AI-generated images, audio, or text when audiences could be misled about what is real.	Skipping disclosure because the purpose is good.	Photorealistic AI content for the public.
3	Bias in AI output	AI reflects patterns in its training data, including stereotypes; humans must review and correct for representation.	Believing AI is neutral.	Stereotyped images or text from a prompt.
4	Confidentiality with AI tools	Don't put confidential or personal data into public AI tools; use approved tools with data protections or remove identifying details.	Assuming deleting a chat undoes the exposure.	Sensitive information and a public chatbot.
5	Copyright and AI	Under U.S. Copyright Office guidance, material generated solely by AI lacks human authorship and generally isn't protected; meaningful human creative control can be.	Assuming paying for the tool or writing a prompt makes the output protectable.	Registering or owning AI-made work.
6	Synthetic likeness and consent	Cloning a real person's voice or face requires that person's informed consent and clear disclosure.	Assuming a company connection grants the right.	Voice cloning or deepfake video of a real person.
7	AI governance guidelines	Team AI guidelines set approved tools, data limits, disclosure rules, and human review with clear accountability.	Blanket bans or no rules.	Leading a team to set AI policy.
8	Prompting with context	Better output comes from prompts that state audience, goal, key message, tone, format, and length.	Rerunning a vague prompt and hoping.	Generic or off-target AI output.

Course scope (public description): Leveraging AI and Technology in Strategic Communications provides students with the current landscape of artificial intelligence (AI), its evolution, and its impact on communications. Students will explore the ethical implications of using AI and other emerging technologies when creating communications content. Students will gain the skills necessary to use AI and other new technologies in ethical and innovative ways, lead teams in devising ethical guidelines for using AI in creating communications and use communication technology to enhance organizational productivity.